

Trailhead Supply Co. - Gear Care Guide

Last updated: January 2026

Good gear lasts for years when you look after it. Here's how to keep your Trailhead equipment trail-ready. Following this guidance also helps preserve your warranty coverage, since damage from improper care is not covered by the Trailhead Guarantee.

Tents

- **Dry before storage.** Always let your tent dry completely before packing it away. Storing a damp tent leads to mildew and coating breakdown.
- **Clean gently.** Use a sponge with cool water and mild, non-detergent soap. Never machine wash a tent.
- **Store loosely.** Keep the tent in a breathable bag in a cool, dry place - not compressed for long periods.

Sleeping Bags

- **Store uncompressed.** Long-term compression damages loft. Store in the large mesh or cotton sack, not the stuff sack.
- **Wash rarely and carefully.** Use a front-loading machine on gentle with a down-specific or tech wash. Dry on low with clean tennis balls to restore loft (down bags).

Footwear

- **Clean after muddy trips.** Remove dirt with a soft brush and water. Caked mud dries out leather and breaks down membranes.
- **Dry naturally.** Air dry away from direct heat. Never put boots next to a fire or heater - high heat cracks adhesives and leather.
- **Re-treat leather** periodically with a suitable conditioner or waterproofing wax.

Down & Insulated Apparel

- **Re-loft after washing.** Tumble dry low with dryer balls so the down redistributes.
- **Store loosely** on a hanger or in a breathable bag.

Restoring Water Resistance (DWR)

Over time, the Durable Water Repellent (DWR) finish on jackets and tents wears off and fabric "wets out." To restore it:

1. Clean the item first (dirt blocks DWR performance).
2. Apply a spray-on or wash-in DWR treatment.
3. Activate with low heat (tumble dry low or a warm iron with a cloth barrier), per the product's care label.

Stoves & Cookware

- **Cool fully before packing.**
- **Hand wash** cookware; avoid abrasive pads on non-stick surfaces.
- **Check fuel connections** for wear before each trip and store fuel canisters separately.